



Reporting a Near-Miss Incident

Near-misses are incidents that don't cause any harm or an accident but could have potentially caused an injury or ill health. You might be tempted to brush off near-miss incidents as no one gets hurt, but it's vital you don't ignore them. Fox Brothers Holdings encourage all members of staff to report near miss incidents

Just because it was a near-miss this time, doesn't mean that it will be next time.

Examples of Near-Misses

A **near-miss** describes all incidents that didn't cause harm but had the potential to. Below are some examples of near misses that could occur in the workplace:

- An employee trips on the loose edge of a rug that they couldn't see because of the poor corridor lighting. They manage to steady themselves by grabbing a bookcase.
- A large piece of construction plant is being reversed on site without being aware of a worker operating behind it.
- A worker's clothing gets caught in machinery; it tears before an injury is sustained.
- A wagon pulls out of the Transport Yard without observing a Give Way Sign

Why Reporting Near-Misses is Important

In all four of these scenarios, the employees managed to avoid an accident and/or injury. However, there could have been a serious incident if they were not able to steady themselves, move out of the way in time or other vehicles/people had been present. Therefore, it's important that these events are reported so we can deal with the hazard before anyone gets hurt. We can identify 'trends' if a series of similar reports are made.

Many people avoid reporting near-misses or minor slips because they are usually seen as embarrassing or funny. If YOU personally believe any incident is a Near-Miss, please report it (Forms can be completed anonymously) The HSE suggests that there are around 90 near-misses for every accident that occurs at work. If we wait for that accident to occur before taking steps to prevent it happening again, we are all taking a **reactive** approach to workplace safety.

Instead, we should take a **proactive** one. Creating a culture that encourages everyone to report any near misses, we will then use the information from incident reports to review our risk assessments, control methods and safety systems. By doing this, we can prevent accidents before they occur.



How to Report a Near-Miss

Near-Miss reports are made through the Fox Group Portal. Scan the QR Code and you will be asked a series of questions regarding the Near-Miss. This information will go directly to the Safety Team who will action accordingly. If you require any further information, contact the Safety Team on 01253 893339 or at FoxSafe@FoxGroup.co.